Writing: A story: it happened while I was…

Day 2 · Writing

What to do: Discuss first (exercise 1), then write in the copybook at home or in class.

Murphy today
Murphy red, Unit 14 (page 39): **14.2** at home; Unit 105 (page 221): **105.1**.

1 Warm-up: talk before you write (5 minutes, in pairs)

1. Think of a time when something unexpected happened while you were doing something ordinary. What were you doing?
2. Where were you, and who was with you?
3. What was the weather like? What were other people doing?
4. What was the first thing you noticed?
5. How did you feel when it happened?
6. What did you do next?
7. Did anybody help you? What did they say?
8. How did the story end? What did you learn?

Choose one topic and tell it to your partner. The partner asks one more question for each of the first 3 answers.

2 Useful words

While · When · As · Just as · Suddenly · At that moment · A few minutes later · In the end

The scene: was / were + -ing · the events: past simple · Unit 5 words: wild · rare · visible · normal · relax · hurt · continue · result

3 The plan: 4 short paragraphs, 120–150 words

1 · Introduction	When and where were you? What were you doing? What was the weather like? (past continuous)
2 · Body 1	Suddenly… What happened? (past simple) Use when, while or as.
3 · Body 2	What did you do? What were other people doing? How did you feel?
4 · Conclusion	How did it end? What did you learn?

Model and your task

Day 2 · Writing

What to do: In the model: was + -ing for the scene and a short event interrupts it.

The Fox in the Garden

It was a quiet Sunday morning in May. I was sitting in the garden with a book, and my little sister was playing with the cat. The sun was shining and the birds were singing.

Suddenly I heard a noise behind the bushes. I stopped reading and looked carefully. A small red fox was standing in the field next to our house! While I was looking at it, the cat saw it, too, and ran into the house.

I did not move. The fox looked at me for a few seconds and then continued its walk. At that moment my sister came out and asked, “What are you looking at?” But the fox was already gone.

It was a rare and wonderful experience. I learned that wild animals are not far from us: we only need to stay calm and look.

A Choose ONE: it happened while I was...

Write 120–150 words. Follow the plan. Use was / were + -ing at least 5 times, the past simple for the events, when / while / as, and 4 words from Unit 5.

B Or: an email to a friend

Write 100–120 words. *Hi ..., You will not believe what happened yesterday! I was ... when ... While I was ... Then ... Write soon!*

Check before you finish

4 paragraphs · the scene in the past continuous, the events in the past simple · when / while / as · 4 Unit 5 words · capital letters and full stops